

JASON McFARLAND | jxmcfarland@gmail.com | 617.922.3599 | [Portfolio](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

Product Experience Leader | Design Systems | 15+ Years in User Experience

Summary

User experience leader who designs complex enterprise workflows and builds design systems, including the first at two companies. Spent three-plus years at Canto, a digital asset management platform, helping shape its artificial intelligence (AI) roadmap and search experience. Uses AI tools (Claude, Figma, Maze) to go from problem to testable prototype in days, and is exploring how design systems can feed Claude Design and Claude Code. Ready to move from shaping product decisions to owning them: the problem, the trade-offs, and the outcome.

Professional Experience

Senior Director, User Experience | Canto | Mar 2022 – Aug 2025

- Championed Cosmo, Canto's first enterprise design system, built on design tokens as Figma variables and aligned to Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1 AA; reached 25% team adoption in six months, cutting design time 25% and merge request approval time 75%.
- Partnered with the lead engineer to keep Cosmo the same in design and code: designers maintained Figma components and variables, they mirrored them in a Storybook library, and recurring syncs aligned specs and updates.
- Tested whether Lovable could build screens from Cosmo that matched the system, refining prompts over several rounds and learning where early models fell short, including context limits.
- Helped introduce AI tools into the team's workflow to make the team more efficient and speed up design exploration and validation.
- Partnered with Product Management to shape the AI roadmap for Canto's digital asset management platform.
- Worked with AI research engineers to evaluate large language model output against real customer data for semantic search, refining prompts and filters to improve early output quality.
- Designed the addition of semantic search to Canto's existing search bar, with an on/off toggle for customers not yet confident in AI, and later extended it to video, flagging matches on the timeline and playing the clip on click.
- Led and did hands-on design for Canto's Monday.com, Universal, and desktop connectors, which brought asset search, attachment, and upload into other tools; kept refining navigation of massive folder structures in tight screen space.

- Built a research practice spanning surveys, Usability Metric for User Experience scoring, NPS, ongoing user outreach, and customer calls with Product Managers, delivering insight summaries that validated initiatives and focused exploration.
- Traced customer complaints about search past the interface to slow back-end performance and inconsistent admin of metadata, and used that evidence to push for a technical fix instead of a redesign.
- Embedded design across delivery, from story sign-off through build reviews and staging tests, and set a shared Definition of Done, reducing cycle time and rework.
- Demoed existing and beta functionality to high-value and at-risk customers, contributing to retention of 4-5 at-risk accounts and upsell of AI functionality to 2 key customers.
- Built Canto's six-person in-house user experience team, replacing an outsourced model.

Head of User Experience | Liaison International | Dec 2016 – Nov 2021

- Launched Liaison's first design system, bringing visual, interaction, and front-end consistency to the platform and reducing design and engineering rework caused by fragmented patterns and code.
- Redesigned Letters end to end, the two-sided recommendations workflow where students request faculty recommendations and faculty complete them; made requests easier to track for both sides and simplified completion with clearer rating mechanisms, reducing support calls on the issue.
- Directed the experience and integration plan that brought two acquired products (Time2Track, SlideRoom) into the Centralized Application Service (CAS) platform as one consistent experience.
- Partnered with Product, Engineering, and Customer teams to launch the California State University system on CAS, contributing to a 15% year-over-year increase in applicant submissions.
- Embedded behavioral analytics into product workflows to guide roadmap prioritization and measure feature effectiveness.
- Led a redesign that made CAS fully usable on mobile, and rebuilt Time2Track as a native iOS app, improving engagement, retention, ease of use, and satisfaction.
- Led accessibility compliance (Section 508, WCAG 2.0) across the platform, managing stakeholder communication and rollout.

Manager of User Experience | Virgin Pulse | Jul 2014 – Dec 2016

- Redesigned the desktop application end to end as a mobile-first v2 platform, native on iOS and then Android, including team-based step challenges and daily tasks, and directed its roadmap; mobile usage surpassed desktop within three months, with a 20% increase in mobile engagement.
- Founded the Design Partner Program, a cohort of strategically important customers whose continuous feedback shaped roadmap priorities.

- Built the company's first repeatable user research and usability testing practice, replacing ad hoc feedback with a structured process.
- Co-founded an innovation team exploring early integrations with Apple TV, Apple Watch, and Amazon Echo, defining success metrics for each concept.

Principal UX Lead & Architect | Fidelity Investments | May 2010 – Jul 2014

- Partnered with senior business and technology leaders to define product vision and long-term experience direction for Fidelity Institutional platforms.
- Simplified complex financial workflows, moving paper-based and desktop-bound trading and account management processes to the web.
- Delivered digital service forms and electronic signature capabilities, reducing turnaround time for institutional clients.
- Managed the Services design team across large, multi-phase programs.

Prior Roles

- UX Design Consultant – 38 Studios
- Senior Information Architect Consultant – VistaPrint
- Senior Design Lead – Allurent
- Senior Information Architect – Keane/ArcStream

Skills

- **Design systems:** component libraries, design tokens, patterns, documentation, governance, adoption strategy, keeping design and code aligned with Engineering
- **Experience design:** interaction design, information architecture, complex multi-step workflows, journey mapping, prototyping, accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA, Section 508)
- **Product:** problem framing, roadmap prioritization, requirements translation and contributing to product requirements documents, experience success metrics, discovery through launch and adoption
- **Research:** research planning, usability testing, surveys, Usability Metric for User Experience scoring, behavioral analytics, synthesis and storytelling
- **AI:** large language model evaluation and prompt refinement, AI-assisted design and prototyping, AI workflow integration (Claude, Claude Design, Claude Code, ChatGPT, Cursor, Lovable, n8n)
- **Delivery:** Agile, Lean, and Waterfall; sprint planning, reviews, and retrospectives; partnering with Engineering through build and release
- **Tools:** Figma, Pendo, Adobe Creative Cloud, Maze, Dovetail, Gong

Education

Bachelor of Science in Mechanical Engineering | Georgia Institute of Technology